# The Sharia AI Compliance Framework

A Dual-Authority Governance Architecture for Islamic Finance

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### Two clauses that accompany this framework everywhere

**No Sharia Supervisory Board has reviewed or endorsed this specification.** It is an engineering proposal for how binding Sharia authority can be integrated into AI lifecycle governance, offered for scholarly and institutional review. This clause is normative, is restated at 9.1, and MUST accompany any presentation of this framework until an endorsement exists and can be named.

**This specification makes no Sharia determination and MUST NOT be read as making one.** It specifies the architecture by which an existing Sharia authority reaches an AI system. What is permissible is for that authority to decide, and nothing in this document substitutes for scholarly opinion on any question of permissibility.

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# Abstract

An Islamic financial institution operates under two binding authorities. A financial supervisor determines what it may do in law. A Sharia Supervisory Board determines what it may do in conscience, and in most such institutions the board's determinations are binding rather than advisory. Both authorities predate artificial intelligence and neither has specified how its authority reaches an AI system.

The institution therefore does what institutions do when a new object arrives without a rule for it. It builds a second process. The AI system passes the civil governance machinery, and then, separately and usually later, it passes a Sharia review conducted by different people, on different evidence, producing different records. Two processes, two record sets, two answers to the question of whether the system may operate, and no defined behaviour when they disagree.

**This specification proposes that the second process is unnecessary and that building it is the error.** Its central move is structural: the Sharia Supervisory Board is constituted as an **authority source at the Regulatory Floor** of the MESA Framework [1], alongside the financial supervisor, so that its determinations cascade downward through the same governance machinery as civil regulation rather than running beside it. An institution operating this framework has one governance system with two authority sources at its floor.

Beneath that constitution sit a **Maqasid risk frame**, which classifies what an AI decision may harm in the terms the authority itself uses rather than in the terms of a Western risk taxonomy, and **three threads** into the institution's existing operational machinery: **dual validation** into model risk management, where a civil track and a Sharia track must both close before approval; the **Halal data certification chain** into data governance; and **Sharia screening** into vendor risk. Escalation is concurrent rather than sequential: a Sharia-material incident routes to the board alongside civil escalation, not after it.

The specification is unusually explicit about what it is not. **No Sharia Supervisory Board has reviewed or endorsed it.** The Halal data certification chain is **author methodology that no standard-setter recognizes**. No standard-setter has issued an instrument governing the interaction between Sharia governance and artificial intelligence. Academic proposals exist; a recognized standard does not. That is what makes this a proposal worth submitting rather than a restatement of practice, and equally what makes it unendorsed. Section 9 states each plainly and states what would falsify the framework.

It is a specification, not a certification scheme, and no conformity assessment body operates against it.

**Keywords:** Islamic finance; Sharia governance; AI governance; dual authority; model risk management; Maqasid al-Sharia; takaful; Islamic banking; evidence architecture; regulated industries.

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# Notation

This specification uses **MUST**, **MUST NOT**, **SHOULD**, **SHOULD NOT** and **MAY** as the normative verbal forms.


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- **MUST** indicates a requirement. An implementation that does not meet it is not conformant with this specification.
- **SHOULD** indicates a recommendation. Departure requires a recorded rationale.
- **MAY** indicates a permission.

**Normative terms in this document bind an institution's engineering and governance practice. They do not bind, qualify or interpret any Sharia determination.** Where this specification says that something MUST happen, it is specifying the machinery, never the ruling the machinery carries.

### Spelling

The canonical name of the framework is the **Sharia AI Compliance Framework (SACF)™**, spelled as first asserted, and that spelling MUST NOT be altered in citation. **Sharia** is used throughout, and the body of authority is written **Sharia Supervisory Board**. Where a cited instrument spells it otherwise, the title is quoted as its publisher printed it, so *Sharīʿah* and *Shari'ah* appear inside references to IFSB and AAOIFI instruments and nowhere else. The difference is orthographic only and denotes one subject.

### Defined terms

**Authority source.** A body whose determinations bind the institution and are satisfied rather than traded against likelihood and impact. A financial supervisor is an authority source. A Sharia Supervisory Board, where the institution has constituted it with binding approval power, is an authority source.

**Binding.** A determination is binding when the institution may not proceed against it, as distinct from advisory, where the institution may proceed having recorded its reasons. **Which of these describes a given board is a matter of that institution's constitution and is not assumed here**, and 2.2 states what changes when the board is advisory.

**Sharia-material.** A decision, system or incident is Sharia-material when its outcome could engage a determination the board has made or would make. **Materiality is determined by the board, not by the engineering function**, and 3.3 specifies how the determination is obtained rather than inferred.

**Dual validation.** The requirement at Section 4 that two independent validation tracks, civil and Sharia, both close before an AI system may be approved for production use.

**Institution.** The accountable legal entity. **Islamic financial institution** means one that has constituted a Sharia Supervisory Board, whether a bank, a takaful operator, a window, or a fintech operating under such a constitution.

Sections 2 through 7 are normative. Sections 1, 8, 9 and 10 are informative, except where they state a requirement using **MUST**.

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# 1. Introduction

## 1.1 The problem

Governance frameworks assume a single apex authority. The institution is answerable to a supervisor; the supervisor's expectations descend through policy into control; and the machinery is built to carry one set of obligations downward. That assumption is invisible until an institution has two apexes, at which point the machinery has no way to represent the second one and the institution improvises.

The improvisation that suggests itself is a parallel process, because an authority the machinery cannot represent can only be given a machinery of its own. It is a reasonable first response and it has three costs that compound.

**The record sets diverge.** Two processes produce two accounts of the same system. When an authority asks what was decided and on what basis, the institution has two answers and must reconcile them after the fact, which is the worst moment to discover that they cannot be reconciled.

**The second process arrives late.** A Sharia review conducted after a system is built is a review of a fait accompli. The finding that a system should have been designed differently arrives when redesigning it is expensive, which exerts steady pressure toward findings that can be accommodated.


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**Disagreement has no defined behaviour.** When the civil track approves and the Sharia track does not, an institution with two processes has a dispute between two committees. An institution with one system and two authority sources at its floor has an obligation that is simply not satisfied, and no system passes with an unsatisfied floor obligation.

### 1.2 What this framework proposes

That the second process is unnecessary. **A governance machinery that can carry one binding authority downward can carry two, if the second is constituted at the same altitude as the first.**

The claim is architectural rather than theological. It says nothing about what a board should determine. It says that once a board has determined something, the institution already owns machinery capable of carrying that determination into a data classification, a validation, a vendor assessment and a deployment decision, and that building a second machinery to do it is duplication that produces divergence.

### 1.3 Contribution

1. **A constitution.** The Sharia Supervisory Board as an authority source at the MESA Regulatory Floor, with the consequences that follow for cascade, evidence and conflict. Section 2.
2. **A risk frame in the authority's own terms.** The Maqasid classification of what an AI decision may harm, so that the board is asked a question in the vocabulary of its own discipline rather than in that of a risk register. Section 3.
3. **Three threads into existing machinery**, specified so that an institution extends what it already operates rather than standing up something new. Sections 4 to 6.
4. **Concurrent escalation.** Section 7.

### 1.4 Scope

Institutions that have constituted a Sharia Supervisory Board and operate AI systems whose decisions may be Sharia-material. The framework assumes the institution already operates civil AI governance, whether organized under ISO/IEC 42001 [8] or otherwise. It is an extension and not a replacement, and an institution without the civil machinery should build that first.

### 1.5 Non-goals

- **Not a source of Sharia rulings.** Stated in the front matter and restated here because it is the misreading that would do the most damage.
- **Not a substitute for a Sharia Supervisory Board.** Nothing here reduces what a board does or automates any part of it.
- **Not a screening methodology for investments.** Sharia screening of securities and counterparties is an established discipline with its own standards. Section 6 concerns the screening of **AI vendors**, which is a different subject.
- **Not a certification scheme.** No conformity assessment body operates against this specification.
- **Not an empirical claim.** Section 9 states what has not been tested.

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## 2. The Constitution (Normative)

### 2.1 The board is an authority source, not a stakeholder

**An institution operating this framework MUST constitute its Sharia Supervisory Board as an authority source at the Regulatory Floor of the MESA Framework [1]**, alongside the financial supervisor and any other body whose determinations bind it.

Three properties follow from that altitude and each is normative.

1. **Its determinations are satisfied rather than weighed.** A Regulatory Floor obligation is not traded against likelihood and impact. An institution MUST NOT record a board determination as a risk to be accepted, and MUST NOT operate a system that contradicts one on the basis that the exposure is small.


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2. **Its determinations cascade.** A determination at the floor descends into the Strategic Compass as mandate, into Operational Machinery as procedure, and into the Technical Substrate as an enforced control, by the same cascade any civil obligation follows. **An institution MUST be able to trace a board determination to the control that enforces it.**
3. **The substrate bounds it.** MESA's enforcement constraint applies without exception: a determination the technical substrate cannot enforce operates at the maturity of the substrate rather than at the maturity of the determination. **A board ruling that only a policy document expresses is not an enforced ruling**, and an institution MUST record it as a documented inability rather than as a control.

### 2.2 What changes when the board is advisory

Not every institution constitutes its board with binding power. Where the board is advisory, **the board MUST NOT be recorded as an authority source**, because doing so would misrepresent the institution's own constitution, and misrepresenting a governance relationship to make a framework fit is the failure this specification is least entitled to commit.

An institution in that position MAY still operate Sections 3 to 7 as procedure, and its Sharia track then produces advice that the accountable executive at approval weighs and records. That is a coherent arrangement. **It is not this framework**, and an institution operating it MUST NOT claim conformance under Section 8.

### 2.3 Where the two authorities conflict

**This framework does not resolve conflicts between authorities and MUST NOT be represented as resolving them.** Where a civil obligation and a board determination cannot both be satisfied, the institution has a governance problem that no architecture dissolves, and the people who resolve it are the board, the supervisor and the institution's counsel.

What the architecture supplies is narrower and still useful. **A conflict MUST surface before the system is built rather than after**, because both authorities are represented at the floor and both cascade into the same design; and **the conflict MUST be recorded as an unsatisfied floor obligation** rather than as a disagreement between functions, which fixes what it is and prevents it being closed by whoever has more standing in the room.

### 2.4 Figure 1: one machinery, two authority sources

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## 3. The Maqasid Risk Frame (Normative)

### 3.1 Why the frame exists

A board asked whether an AI system is acceptable, in the vocabulary of a risk register, is being asked a question in someone else's language. The answer will be shaped by the question, and a framework that forces the authority to reason in the engineering function's categories has quietly moved the determination toward the engineering function.

**An institution MUST classify what an AI decision may harm in terms the board's own discipline uses.** The Maqasid al-Sharia, the higher objectives the law is understood to protect, supply that vocabulary: faith, life, intellect, lineage and wealth.

### 3.2 What the frame does and does not do

The frame is a **classification instrument, not a determination**. It states which objectives a system's decisions could engage, so that the board is asked a precise question about a specific exposure rather than a general question about a technology.

**It MUST NOT be used to conclude that a system is acceptable.** A system that engages no objective still requires whatever review the board's own procedure requires, and an institution MUST NOT treat an empty classification as a clearance.


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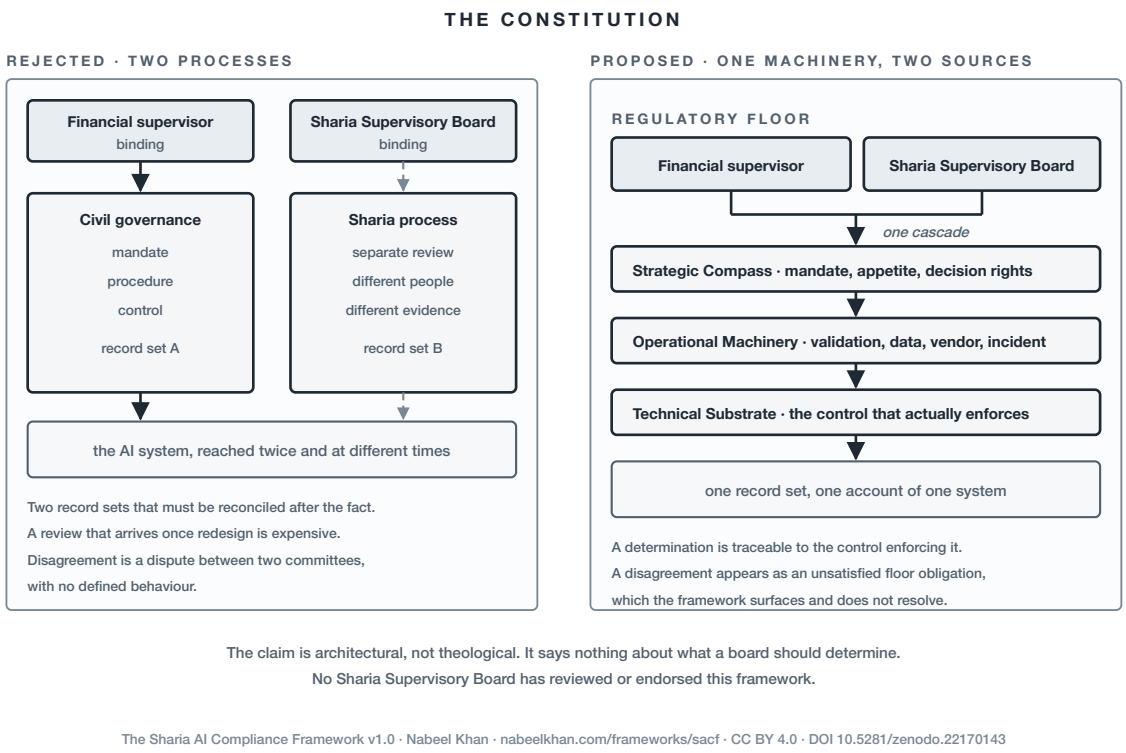



**Figure 1.** The constitution. On the left, the arrangement this framework rejects: a civil governance process and a separate Sharia process, producing two record sets, meeting late, with no defined behaviour on disagreement. On the right, the arrangement it proposes: both authorities at the Regulatory Floor, one cascade, one record set, and a disagreement that appears as an unsatisfied floor obligation rather than as a dispute between functions.

### 3.3 Materiality is determined, not inferred

**Sharia-materiality MUST be determined by the board and MUST NOT be inferred by the engineering or governance function.**

An institution MUST obtain the determination in one of two forms, and MUST record which it relied on.

- **A standing determination**, in which the board states in advance which classes of decision are material, so that the classification at 3.1 routes systems automatically. This is the form that scales and SHOULD be sought.
- **A per-system determination**, obtained before design proceeds.

**An institution MUST NOT operate a rule of its own devising that decides which systems the board sees.** A filter written by the party whose work would otherwise be reviewed is not a filter the review can rely on.

### 3.4 The evidence the frame produces

A Maqasid classification record per AI system, stating the objectives its decisions could engage, the reasoning, the date, and which form of determination at 3.3 established materiality.

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## 4. Thread One: Dual Validation (Normative)

### 4.1 The requirement

Where a system is Sharia-material, **model logic MUST pass two independent validation tracks, and both MUST close before the system may be approved for production use.**

- The **civil track** is the independent validation the institution's model risk discipline already requires [3].
- The **Sharia track** examines whether the model's logic, its inputs, its objective and its foreseeable outputs are consistent with the board's determinations.


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Both tracks close, or the system is not approved. **A closure in one track MUST NOT be recorded as partial satisfaction of the other.**

### 4.2 Independence

**The two tracks MUST be independent of each other and each MUST be independent of the team that built the system.**

Independence between the tracks matters as much as independence from the builder, and for a reason easy to miss. A Sharia validator shown the civil validation first is anchored by it, and an institution that runs the tracks sequentially to save effort has produced one validation and an endorsement. **The tracks SHOULD therefore be run concurrently**, and where they are run sequentially the institution MUST record that they were and MUST NOT represent the second as independent.

### 4.3 What the Sharia track examines

At minimum: the decision the model makes and whether that decision class is one the board has ruled on; the inputs, including whether any input is itself derived from an impermissible source; the objective the model optimizes, since an objective may be impermissible where each individual decision is not; and the foreseeable distribution of outputs, since a model whose typical output is unobjectionable may have a tail that is not.

**The final item is where this differs most from a conventional validation.** A civil validation asks whether the model performs. A Sharia validation must also ask what the model would do in cases it will encounter rarely, because a rare impermissible outcome is not made permissible by being rare.

### 4.4 Evidence

A dual-validation record per Sharia-material system, showing **two independent closures**, each with its own validator named, its own scope stated and its own date. Each closure SHOULD be stated as a BOE Declaration [2], naming the boundary the validation fixes, the freedom it grants and the evidence that the boundary held, so that it joins the institution's single record set rather than sitting apart from it. **A single record signed by two people is not a dual-validation record**, and neither is one closure endorsed twice.

### 4.5 Figure 2: the three threads

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## 5. Thread Two: The Halal Data Certification Chain (Normative, and Author Methodology)

### 5.1 The disclosure comes first

**The Halal data certification chain specified in this section is an original construct of this framework. No standard-setter recognizes such a chain as of the date of this specification.** It MUST be presented as author methodology and MUST NOT be presented as an existing requirement of any Sharia standard, any supervisor, or any body.

This clause is normative and precedes the specification of the chain deliberately, because a reader who encounters the construct first and the disclosure afterwards has already formed the wrong impression of its status.

### 5.2 The problem it addresses

Where a board has determined that certain data may not be used, the institution must be able to show that it was not used. In a conventional data pipeline it usually cannot. Data arrives, is transformed, is aggregated with other data, and the resulting training set has no property that records what went into it. The institution's assurance is that nobody put the wrong data in, and that assurance is a recollection.

### 5.3 The chain

**An institution claiming a Halal data certification MUST maintain an attested chain in three parts**, each of which is an artifact rather than an assertion.


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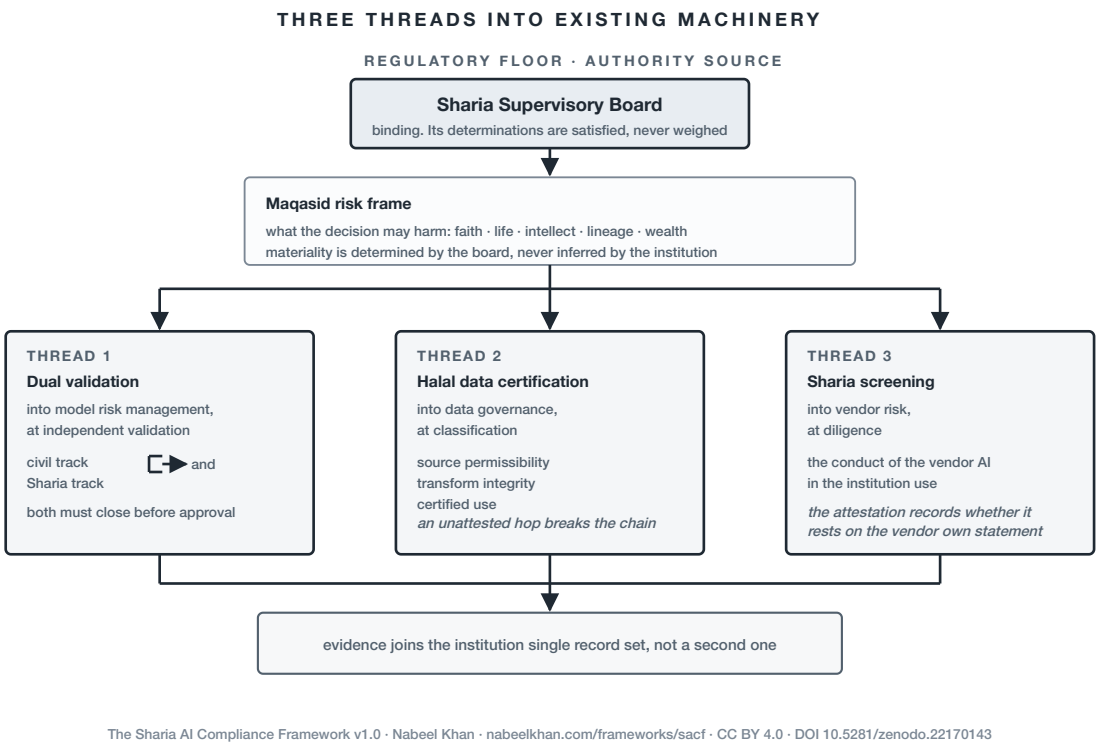



**Figure 2.** The three threads into existing machinery. Dual validation enters model risk management at the independent validation step, and both tracks must close before approval. The Halal data certification chain enters data governance at classification and follows the data to the point of use. Sharia screening enters vendor risk at diligence. Each thread extends a discipline the institution already operates rather than standing up a parallel one.

1. **Source permissibility.** For each data source, a record of whether the board has determined it permissible for the use proposed, and the form of that determination per 3.3.
2. **Transform integrity.** For each transformation between the source and the point of use, an attestation that the transformation did not introduce data from an unattested source. **An unattested hop breaks the chain**, and a chain with a break is not a chain: the purpose of the artifact is end-to-end reconstruction and a single gap defeats it.
3. **Certified use.** A record at the point of use stating which chain the data arrived by and which determination permits it.

### 5.4 What the chain is not

It is not a certification issued by anyone. **The institution certifies to itself that it maintained the chain**, and the board may rely on that or not. Nothing here creates a certificate, a mark, or a status that could be represented to a customer or a counterparty, and an institution MUST NOT represent a maintained chain as an external certification.

### 5.5 Evidence

A certification chain record per data set for which a permissibility determination exists, and per AI system consuming it.

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## 6. Thread Three: Sharia Vendor Screening (Normative)

### 6.1 The requirement

Where an AI capability is obtained from a third party and is used in a Sharia-material system, **the vendor MUST be screened against the board's criteria as part of the institution's ordinary vendor diligence** [3], and MUST NOT be screened in a separate later process.


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### 6.2 What is screened

The subject of the screening is **the conduct of the vendor's AI in the institution's use**, which is a narrower and more tractable question than the permissibility of the vendor as an enterprise. The institution MUST record which it screened, because the two are frequently conflated and produce different answers.

Where the board has also determined criteria about the vendor as an enterprise, those apply, and this framework carries them without modifying them.

### 6.3 The limit of what screening can establish

**A vendor's model is usually not inspectable.** An institution screening a third-party model is screening what the vendor is willing to state, plus whatever evaluation the institution can perform from outside. **A screening attestation MUST record which of the two it rests on**, and an institution MUST NOT represent a vendor's own statement as an independent finding.

This limit is real and is not solved here. An institution for which the limit is unacceptable has a decision to make about the vendor rather than about the screening.

### 6.4 Evidence

A screening attestation per screened vendor, stating the criteria applied, the basis at 6.3, the date, and the determination.

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## 7. Escalation (Normative)

### 7.1 Concurrent, not sequential

**An incident classified as Sharia-material MUST route to the Sharia Supervisory Board concurrently with civil escalation, and MUST NOT route afterwards.**

Sequential escalation appears reasonable and is not. It means the institution has decided what happened, decided what it will do, and then informed the authority whose determination should have shaped both. The board is presented with a resolved matter and its remaining options are to accept the resolution or to reopen it, which is not the position an authority at the floor should be in.

### 7.2 What routes

The classification at 3.3 governs. Where materiality is unclear at the moment of an incident, **the institution MUST escalate**, because an incident wrongly escalated costs the board's time and an incident wrongly withheld costs the board's authority.

### 7.3 What the board receives

At minimum: what the system did, the reconstruction from the upstream evidence records [3], which determination is engaged, the containment already applied and why, and what the institution proposes. **The reconstruction MUST be evidence produced at the time of the decisions in question**, not an account assembled afterwards.

### 7.4 Figure 3: escalation

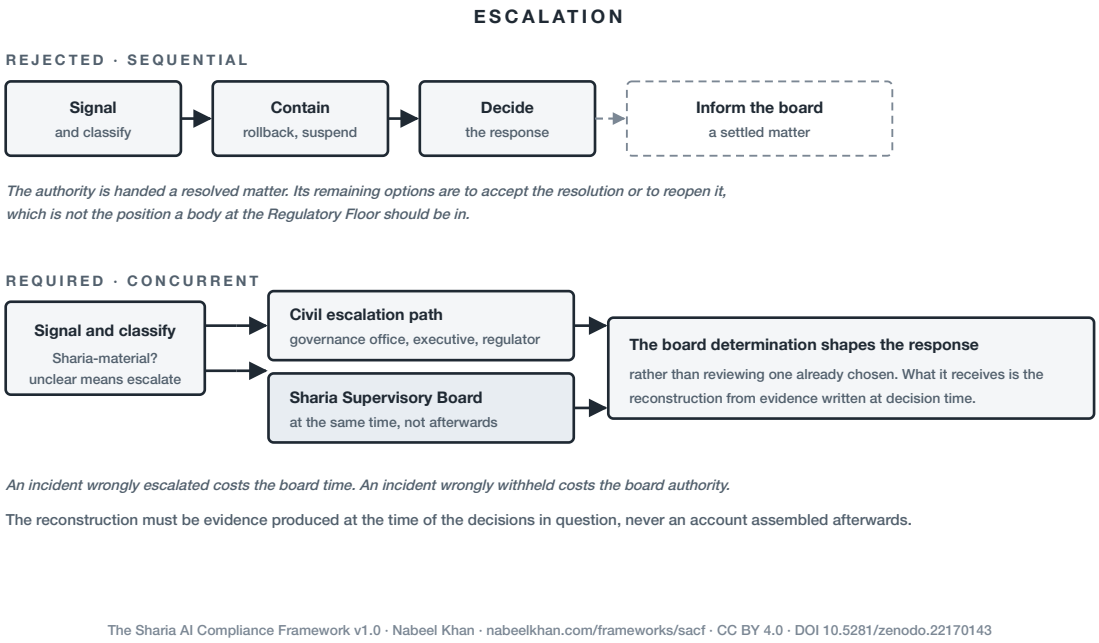
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## 8. Conformance (Normative)

### 8.1 Self-declared

Conformance is **self-declared**. No conformity assessment body operates against this specification, and no third party is accredited to assess a claim made under it.


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**Figure 3.** Escalation. Above, the sequential arrangement this framework rejects, in which the institution resolves an incident and then informs the board, leaving the authority to accept or reopen a settled matter. Below, concurrent escalation, in which the board receives the reconstruction at the same time as the civil escalation path and its determination shapes the response rather than reviewing it.

**A conformance claim under this specification is not, and MUST NOT be represented as, a statement that the institution is Sharia-compliant.** It states that the machinery by which the board's authority reaches the institution's AI systems is built as specified. Whether the institution is compliant is the board's determination and nobody else's.

## 8.2 What conformance requires

1. The board is constituted with binding approval power and is recorded as a Regulatory Floor authority source, per 2.1.
2. A Maqasid classification record exists per AI system, and materiality was determined by the board in one of the two forms at 3.3.
3. Every Sharia-material system carries a dual-validation record showing two independent closures, per 4.4.
4. Where a Halal data certification chain is claimed, it is attested end to end with no unattested hop, per 5.3.
5. Every vendor supplying AI capability to a Sharia-material system carries a screening attestation stating its basis, per 6.4.
6. Sharia-material incidents in the period escalated concurrently, per 7.1.
7. Each board determination relied on is traceable to the control that enforces it, or is recorded as a documented inability, per 2.1.

## 8.3 What accompanies a claim

A published claim MUST carry the two clauses in the front matter of this specification, the date of the evidence, and the version claimed against.

## 8.4 What it does not mean

- It does not mean the institution is Sharia-compliant. See 8.1.
- It does not mean the board has endorsed this framework. **No board has.**
- It does not mean the institution has been assessed. Nobody assessed it.
- It does not mean a certification exists. None does.


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# 9. Limitations, What Has Not Been Tested, and Falsification

## 9.1 No Sharia Supervisory Board has reviewed or endorsed this specification

Restated here, in the section a critical reader turns to first, because it is the most important thing about this document. **It is an engineering proposal for how binding Sharia authority can be integrated into AI lifecycle governance, offered for scholarly and institutional review.**

The proposal is made by someone who is not a Sharia scholar, about the machinery through which scholars' authority would operate. That is a legitimate thing for an engineer to propose and it is not a legitimate thing for an engineer to settle. **The acceptance of the construct at 2.1 is the gate to everything else in this document**, and it has not been sought and obtained from any named board.

## 9.2 The central construct is asserted, not accepted

**That a board would accept constitution as an authority source inside a civil governance machinery is asserted here and has not been publicly accepted by any board.**

A board might reasonably decline. It might hold that its authority is not of the same kind as a supervisor's and should not be represented as though it were; that a separate process is the visible independence its authority requires; or that the machinery, being designed by the institution, is not neutral ground. **None of those objections is answered in this document**, and each would be a sufficient reason to reject the framework's central move.

## 9.3 The Halal data certification chain is unrecognized

Restated from 5.1. No standard-setter recognizes such a chain. It is the most likely part of this framework to be superseded by an actual standard, and an institution adopting it should expect to migrate.

## 9.4 The field is open, which cuts both ways

The relevant standing instruments are **IFSB-10** [5], issued December 2009, and **IFSB-31** [6], issued July 2025. IFSB-31 was examined for this specification and **contains no treatment of artificial intelligence or machine learning**. **AAOIFI has issued no standard or exposure draft on artificial intelligence** as of the date of this specification; its recorded activity in the area is a collaboration memorandum for generative AI training programmes signed 27 February 2025 [7], and conference programming.

That the field is open is what makes this specification worth submitting as candidate input rather than redundant. It is also why it has no authority behind it, and a reader should hold both facts at once.

## 9.5 Not tested anywhere

**No institution has been observed operating this framework**, connected to the author or otherwise. There is no implementation profile, no scored instrument, and no published result. Everything in Sections 2 through 7 is architectural.

## 9.6 What would falsify the framework

**The framework is falsified if an institution operating the single-machinery constitution is found unable to satisfy both authorities from one set of records, so that a second and parallel record set has to be created for the Sharia authority in practice.**

The central claim is that one governance system with two authority sources at its floor is sufficient for both. A parallel record set appearing under operation refutes it by observation rather than by opinion, and it is observable by any party with access to the institution's records.

Two narrower findings would refute parts of it. If Sharia Supervisory Boards presented with the construct at 2.1 hold that it misrepresents the nature of their authority, the constitution fails at its foundation and Section 2 does not survive. And if dual validation run concurrently is found to produce the same findings as a Sharia review conducted after a civil validation, then 4.2's independence requirement is cost without benefit.


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### 9.7 Research questions

1. Would a Sharia Supervisory Board accept constitution as an authority source inside a civil governance machinery, and if not, what constitution would it accept?
2. Does a Sharia validation run concurrently with a civil one produce different findings from one run afterwards?
3. What proportion of AI decisions in an Islamic financial institution are in fact Sharia-material, and does a standing determination at 3.3 classify them as accurately as a per-system determination?
4. Is an attested data chain achievable at the scale of a production training pipeline, and at what cost?

**Scholars, boards and institutions willing to engage with any of these are invited to make contact through the ORCID record in the front matter.** Question one is the one this framework most needs answered, and it cannot be answered by its author.

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## 10. Versioning

**The major number** changes when a change could make a previously conformant institution non-conformant: a requirement in Section 8 is added or tightened, a thread's minimum evidence changes, or the constitution at 2.1 changes.

**The minor number** changes for additions and clarifications that cannot, including the addition of an endorsement, a mapping to a standard-setter instrument once one exists, or a corrected limitation.

**If a Sharia Supervisory Board endorses this framework**, the endorsement, the board and its date MUST appear in the specification and the clauses at 9.1 and 8.4 MUST be revised to state precisely what was endorsed and what was not. **A general endorsement MUST NOT be represented as endorsement of every clause.**

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## 11. References

Every reference was verified against a live primary source on 29 August 2026, each with a deliberate failing control, because a check that cannot fail proves nothing.

[1] Khan, N. A. (2026). *The MESA Framework: A Four-Altitude Diagnostic Model for Institutional AI Governance. Framework Specification.* Zenodo. Concept DOI https://doi.org/10.5281/zenodo.22109836

[2] Khan, N. A. (2026). *A Pattern Language for Production LLM Platforms: Governed Routing, Agent Orchestration, and AI-Native Delivery. Pattern Language Specification.* Zenodo. Concept DOI https://doi.org/10.5281/zenodo.22109864

[3] Khan, N. A. (2026). *The Defensible AI Framework Registry: Canonical Names, Definitions and Relationships for the Governed Production AI Discipline. Registry Specification.* Zenodo. Concept DOI https://doi.org/10.5281/zenodo.22170112

[4] Khan, N. A. (2026). *AI Governance and Compliance Frameworks for the Middle East: The Enterprise Playbook.* First Edition. iSystematic Inc. ISBN 978-1-0678960-1-0

[5] Islamic Financial Services Board (2009). *IFSB-10, Guiding Principles on Shariah Governance Systems for Institutions Offering Islamic Financial Services.* December 2009.

[6] Islamic Financial Services Board (2025). *IFSB-31, Guiding Principles for Effective Supervision of Shariah Governance.* July 2025. Examined for this specification; contains no treatment of artificial intelligence or machine learning.

[7] Accounting and Auditing Organization for Islamic Financial Institutions (2025). *AAOIFI signs collaboration MoU with the UK-based ICMA Digital Academy to introduce Gen-AI training programs in IFIs.* Announcement, 27 February 2025. A training collaboration, not a standard or an exposure draft.

[8] International Organization for Standardization and International Electrotechnical Commission (2023). *ISO/IEC 42001:2023, Information technology. Artificial intelligence. Management system.* First edition, December 2023. Cited as the institutional-altitude management system this framework does not duplicate.


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**A note on what is not cited.** No Sharia source is cited in support of any proposition in this document, because this document advances no Sharia proposition. Where the Maqasid are named at Section 3, they are named as the vocabulary a board uses, and the content of that vocabulary is the board's to state.

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# Appendix A. Publication Provenance

**A.1** First public version. Not peer reviewed, and specifically **not reviewed by any Sharia authority**. Deposited on Zenodo, which confers a DOI, a timestamp and citability. Zenodo does not confer standard status, and nothing in this document uses that word for itself.

**A.2** The framework was developed as threads through chapter 7 of [4] and through its model risk, data governance and vendor risk chapters. This document is its first standalone statement, and the first in which the constitution at 2.1 is stated as the framework's central move rather than as an implementation detail.

**A.3** No preprint identifier exists and no preprint relation is asserted in this record's metadata.

**A.4** Publication order. This record is sixth of eight and publishes before the Defensible AI Framework Registry [3], which publishes last because it cites the final identifier of every record it registers. Registry entry REG-08 remains the canonical statement of this framework's relationships and governs where the two describe the same relationship. The registry's concept DOI is reserved in advance and is carried by reference [3]; it resolves when that record is published.

**A.5** The author is not a Sharia scholar and holds no qualification in Islamic jurisprudence. **This is stated as a limitation on what the document can be relied on for**, and it is the reason Section 9.1 exists in the form it does. The author operates a consulting practice applying this framework, which is a further conflict of interest stated here.

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# Document History

| Version | Date | Summary |
|---|---|---|
| 1.0 | 30 August 2026 | First public version. The constitution, the Maqasid risk frame, the three threads, concurrent escalation, self-declared conformance, and the two normative honesty clauses |

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# About the Author

Nabeel Khan is an enterprise AI architect and governance advisor, and Founder & Solutions Architect at iSystematic Inc. He has spent twenty-five years architecting enterprise data and machine-learning systems in government, healthcare, financial services and telecommunications across three continents, grounded in TOGAF, DMBOK, ISO 27001 and SOC 2.

He works on governed production AI; systems whose authority is bounded by the architecture, whose decisions carry the evidence needed to defend them, and whose behaviour the institution can explain afterwards. The frameworks specified here, and the regulatory knowledge behind them, are published as machine-accessible AI expertise and are callable over MCP without a key at mcp.nabeelkhan.com/api/mcp, so a reader may query this specification's contents directly and receive answers carrying their source.

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**Academic citation:**

```
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(Version 1.0). Zenodo. https://doi.org/10.5281/zenodo.22170143
```

The DOI given is the concept DOI and always resolves to the latest version. Cite it unless you need to pin one specific version.

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